

NOKWANDA MHLONGO

Johannesburg, Gauteng

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dynamic and results-driven Framework Compliance Senior Analyst (IT Audit) with over 5 years of experience in IT auditing, compliance, and risk management. Proven expertise in leading Continuous Monitoring Programs, conducting vulnerability scans, and ensuring compliance with industry standards such as SOC 2, ISO 27001/2, ISO 27701, ISO 22301, ISO 14001 (ESG), and NIST 800-53.

Certified ISO 14001:2015 Internal Auditor, Project Management Practitioner, and dual AI Masterclass graduate with a strong focus on leveraging AI to enhance productivity and innovation. Currently contributing to third-party risk management, tracking, reporting, and triaging risks to ensure organizational resilience. Passionate about driving operational excellence, fostering collaboration, and making a positive social impact through community outreach.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mimecast

Framework Compliance Senior Analyst (ISO Tester / Continuous Monitoring)

Johannesburg, Gauteng | July 2022 – Present

- **Compliance Leadership:**
 - Directed the Continuous Monitoring Program, ensuring adherence to StateRAMP requirements and delivering all monthly and annual compliance reports on time.
 - Conducted vulnerability scans and risk assessments, identifying and mitigating potential threats to organizational security.
 - Ensured compliance with industry standards, including SOC 2, ISO 27001/2, ISO 27701, ISO 22301, ISO 14001 (ESG), and NIST 800-53.
 - Facilitated ESG compliance testing, providing detailed findings and actionable recommendations to senior management.
- **Third-Party Risk Management:**

- Collaborated with the Risk Department to follow up, track, report, and triage risks as part of the Third-Party Risk Management Team.
- Conducted comprehensive risk assessments of critical third-party vendors, ensuring alignment with organizational and regulatory requirements.
- Enhanced vendor risk reporting processes, improving visibility into third-party risk profiles and ensuring timely resolution of identified issues.
- **Process Optimization:**
 - Identified key controls, assessed design deficiencies, and implemented process improvements to enhance operational efficiency.
 - Maintained a comprehensive findings follow-up program, ensuring timely resolution of compliance issues and continuous improvement.
- **Project Management:**
 - Successfully served as PMO for all assigned projects, ensuring timely completion and alignment with organizational goals.
 - Completed MICT deliverables, driving project success and meeting compliance objectives.
- **AI Integration:**
 - Leveraged AI tools to streamline compliance monitoring activities, including anomaly detection in audit data and predictive risk assessments.
 - Applied AI-enhanced skills such as prompt engineering and data generation to improve reporting accuracy and efficiency.

Auditor General South Africa (AGSA)

Information Technology Auditor

Johannesburg, Gauteng | April 2021 – July 2022

- Planned and executed IT audits, ensuring alignment with governance policies, SLA agreements, and regulatory requirements.
- Assessed IT service continuity, security management, and user access controls to identify risks and recommend mitigation strategies.
- Conducted IT risk assessments and implemented mitigation plans to address vulnerabilities.

- Performed data analysis using **ACL** to support audit findings and deliver actionable recommendations.
- Delivered comprehensive audit reports to senior management, improving IT governance and operational resilience.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certification	Issuing Body	Date	Details
Internal Auditor – Environmental Management Systems (ISO 14001:2015)	BSI Training Academy	April 2025	Certificate No. FNR-01098905
Project Management: Foundations and Initiation	University of Colorado Boulder (Coursera)	November 2025	Cosera
Hands-on AI Masterclass I: Fundamentals	you.com × PAIR	2025	Distinction – Prompt engineering, AI-assisted writing, AI research
Hands-on AI Masterclass II: Proficiency	you.com × PAIR	March 2026	Pass – AI strategy, data generation, intermediate prompt engineering

COMMUNITY & SOCIAL IMPACT

- **Tomorrow Trust Foundation – Mandela Day Activities:**
 - Volunteered in community activities, focusing on electronics and robotics to inspire future technology innovators.
 - Enabled hands-on learning experiences for children and adults, promoting STEM education.
- **School Outreach Programme:**
 - Participated in educational outreach sessions, supporting students and instructors in underserved communities.
 - Promoted digital literacy and technology awareness among youth.

EDUCATION

Qualification	Institution	Result
BSc in Computer Science	Durban University of Technology (DUT)	60%
Diploma in Software Development	Durban University of Technology (DUT)	74.5%

SKILLS

Governance, Risk & Compliance:

SOC 2 · ISO 27001/2 · ISO 22301 · ISO 27701 · ISO 14001 (ESG) · NIST 800-53 · StateRAMP · FedRAMP · Third-Party Risk Management

Auditing & Risk Management:

IT Audit Planning & Execution · Continuous Monitoring · Vulnerability Scanning · Risk Assessment & Triage · Findings Follow-Up

Project Management:

Agile Project Management · PMO · MICT Deliverables · Project Planning & Initiation · Stakeholder Management

AI & Technology Tools:

Prompt Engineering · AI-Assisted Writing & Research · AI for Data Generation · AI Strategy · ACL Data Analysis · MS Office Suite

Soft Skills:

Analytical Thinking · Problem-Solving · Team Collaboration · Communication · Dependability · Attention to Detail

References available upon request.
